neighbours were being hacked or roasted alive?' The note ended with the declaration that 'Bombay is not for burning'.

During the time of unrest, when he was travelling home from the airport, Ratan said that he witnessed 'huts burning, destroyed fronts of buildings, glass strewn on the road and police deployment'. He was also informed of the riots by 'affected employees' and he was pained to see the wanton destruction during his 'visit to the riot-affected areas in Worli'.

Ratan reached out to those affected and 'tried to help riot-hit employees with temporary shelter, transport' and also 'rescued a Muslim employee from Parel'. The company staff was also 'delegated responsibility to help out where required'. Ratan also tried to visit Andheri and Dharavi but was 'advised not to go beyond Worli as it was unsafe'. He declared that his 'trips to see who was suffering', his 'public appeal' and his 'assistance work' were not 'confined to concern for any one community.' In fact, his 'appeal for restoring peace' was written 'from his heart' and he 'stood by what he had said'.

Deposing before the Justice B.N. Srikrishna Commission after the riots, Ratan said: 'I was quite perturbed by what was happening around in Bombay during that time.' He said he 'endeavoured to bring aid and succour to the distressed riot victims', and also called on Chief Minister Sudhakarrao Naik, along with Keshub Mahindra. He also visited some riot victims and 'participated in a peace rally in front of VT station in 1993'. His sisters and he drove around the city and helped some people who were affected.

Some five years later, Ratan said that because of what he had done and said, he had to face the Commission, standing in the witness box for five hours. During the hearing, he was advised by Justice Srikrishna not to say the things that he had. Ratan replied: 'If it happens again, I'll do it again. I felt a sense of fulfilment that I did what I thought was right.' A leading newspaper that reported the story commented, 'A Tata till the end'.

When it came to translating his idea of nationalism into economic growth of the country, Ratan pursued several projects of which two deserve special mention—the coal liquefaction in collaboration with Sasol of South Africa and the Mundra power project (discussed in previous chapters).

Ratan pushes projects and schemes that most other industrialists may be wary of. He would do this saying, 'We need to do this because the country